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Analytical Reasoning-Strong and Weak Arguments

Directions: In marking decisions about important questions, it is desirable to be able to distinguish between 'strong' arguments and 'weak' arguments. 'Strong' arguments are those which are both important and directly related to the question. 'Weak' arguments are those which are of minor importance and also may not be directly related to the question or may be related to a trivial aspect of the question.

Each question below is followed by two arguments numbered I and II. You have to decide which of the arguments is a 'strong' argument and which is a 'weak' argument.

Give answer (1) if only argument I is strong.

Give answer (2) if only argument II is strong.

Give answer (3) if either I or II is strong.

Give answer (4) if neither I nor II is strong.

Give answer (5) if both I and II are strong.

1. **Statement:** Should there be capital punishment for those who are found guilty of rape charges?

Arguments: I. Yes, this is the only way to eliminate such atrocities on women.

II. No, this will lead to more violence as culprits may even kill the rape victims.

Ans. (4)

The use of term 'only' in argument I makes it invalid.

2. **Statement:** Should all the non-performing employees in the public sector be compulsorily retrenched from service?

Arguments: I. No, this will give an unjust handle to the management and they may use it indiscriminately.

II. Yes, this will help increase the level of efficiency of these organisations and these will become profitable establishments.

Ans. (2)



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Analytical Reasoning-Strong and Weak Arguments

Only argument II seems to be suitable.

3. **Statement:** Should there be compulsory medical examination of both the man and the woman before they marry each other?

Arguments: I. No, this is an intrusion to the privacy of an individual and hence cannot be tolerated.

II. Yes, this will substantially reduce the risk of giving birth to children with serious ailments.

Ans. (2)

Only argument II is strong.

4. **Statement:** Should all the drugs patented and manufactured in western countries be first tried out on sample basis before giving licence for sale to general public in India?

Arguments: I. Yes, many such drugs require different doses and duration for Indian population and hence it is necessary.

II. No, this is just not feasible and hence cannot be implemented.

Ans. (1)

Only argument I seems to be strong.

5. **Statement:** Should all the foreign banks immediately be asked to close down their operations in India?

Arguments: I. No, this will have an adverse impact on Indian economy.

II. Yes, this is the only way to make the Indian banks survive and prosper.

Ans. (4)

Neither of the arguments is strong.

6. **Statement:** Should the admission to professional courses in India be given only on merit without any concession to any particular group of students?



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Analytical Reasoning-Strong and Weak Arguments

Arguments: I. Yes, this will improve the quality of the professionals as they will be able to complete the courses successfully.

II. No, this will keep large number of socially and economically backward students out of the reach of the professional courses.

Ans. (2)

Our country seeks to support educationally and economically backward classes for their overall growth and development. Therefore, argument I is not strong.

7. **Statement:** Should the state governments be allowed to retain major shares of the central taxes collected in the respective state?

Arguments: I. No, the central government should receive the major share as most of the developmental programmes are funded by the central government.

II. Yes, most of the state governments are short of funds and they badly need more funds.

Ans. (4)

In order to decide whether the argument is strong or not first decide the desirability of the statement. Therefore, neither of the arguments is strong.

8. **Statement:** Should all the private sector banks be immediately merged with the public sector banks?

Arguments: I. No, the private sector banks are profit making entities and hence they should not be merged.

II. Yes, this will safeguard the hard earned money of the customers and their interest will be secured.

Ans. (4)

The reason mentioned in the argument I is not convincing. Therefore, argument I is not strong. Argument II does not answer the question how public sector banks will safeguard the money of the customers. Thus, argument II is also not strong.

9. **Statement:** Should the in-charge of all the police stations in the country be transferred every two years?

Arguments: I. No, this will create lot of administrative hassles and also will create lot of inconvenience to the police officers.



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Analytical Reasoning-Strong and Weak Arguments

II. Yes, this is the only way to eradicate the nexus between police officers and anti social elements.

Ans. (4)

Neither of the arguments is strong. The use of term 'only' in the argument II makes it invalid.

10. **Statement:** Should the oil companies be allowed to fix the price of petroleum products depending on market conditions?

Arguments: I. Yes, this is the only way to make the oil companies commercially viable.

II. No, this will put additional burden on the retail prices of essential commodities and will cause lot of hardships to the masses.

Ans. (2)

Only argument II seems to be strong. Hike in prices of petroleum products affects the price structure of most of the essential commodities. The use of term "only" in the argument I makes it invalid.

11. **Statement:** Should the government substantially increase the water tax to the farmers for the fields which are supplied with water for irrigation?

Arguments: I. No, the farmers are even otherwise hard pressed to meet their expenditure for cultivating their lands.

II. Yes, the rich farmers make huge profits, as the water tax for irrigation is considerably lower.

Ans. (1)

According to question only arguments I is strong.

12. **Statement:** Should all those who are arriving from other countries and are suffering from communicable diseases be sent back to the countries which they came from?

Arguments: I. Yes, this is the only way to curb the spread of communicable diseases.

II. No, this is just not advisable.

Ans. (4)

According to question neither arguments I nor arguments II is strong.



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Analytical Reasoning-Strong and Weak Arguments

13. **Statement:** Should all those secondary schools from which less than fifty percent students pass the SSC examination be closed down?

Arguments: I. No, instead these schools should be advised to take corrective measures to improve the pass percentage.

II. Yes, this will deliver a strong message to all the secondary schools.

Ans. (1)

According to question only arguments I is strong.

14. **Statement:** Should there be a total ban on giving new licenses to open liquor shop throughout the country?

Arguments: I. Yes, this will help decrease in consumption of alcohol in future.

II. No, the Government will earn additional taxes by way of giving new licenses as this will increase the sale of liquor.

Ans. (4)

According to question neither arguments I nor argument II strong.

15. **Statement:** Should the habit of late coming in educational institutions be checked?

Arguments: I. No. Until it affects the work.

II. Yes. Discipline must be maintained.

Ans. (2)

Only argument II is strong.

16. **Statement:** Should seniority be the only criterion for the promotion?

Arguments: I. No. All the senior employees are not interested in promotion.

II. Yes. Otherwise senior employees do feel humiliated.

Ans. (4)



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Analytical Reasoning-Strong and Weak Arguments

Neither of the argument is strong.

17. **Statement:** Should children be prevented completely from watching television?

Arguments:

I. No. We get vital information regarding education through television.

II. Yes. It hampers the study of children.

Ans. (1)

Only argument I is strong. Now-a-days television is an essential means to provide useful academic information. Therefore, it is not desirable to prevent children from watching selected programmes on television. For the same reason, argument II is invalid.

18. **Statement:** Should trade unions be banned completely?

Arguments:

I. No. This is the only way through which employees can put their demands before management.

II. Yes. Employees get their illegal demands fulfilled through these unions.

Ans. (1)

Only argument I is strong. It is true that employees put their genuine demands before the management through the trade unions. Therefore, it is not judicious to ban the trade unions completely. It is true that employees compel the management in some instances to concede their some illegal demands through the unions but the solution suggested is not appropriate.

19. **Statement:** Should women be given equal opportunity in matter of employment in every field?

Arguments:

I. Yes. They are equally capable.

II. No. They have to shoulder household responsibilities too.

Ans. (1) Only argument I is strong. Women are equally capable and they should be given equal opportunity in matter of employment. Argument II makes no point.



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Analytical Reasoning-Strong and Weak Arguments

20. **Statement:**Should government established higher level Institutes of Technology (IITs) be privatised?

Arguments: I. Yes, Privatisation will make these institutes financially healthy, competitive and quality conscious.

II. Yes, Privatisation is the key of the new era-can we survive without it?

Ans. (4)

Neither of the arguments is strong. It is true that privatisation may make Institutes of Technology financially healthy and competitive considering the prevalent trend of market. But it cannot be taken as universally true. Hence, argument I is not strong. The second argument lacks any substance and hence it is not strong.

21. **Statement:**Should vacations of court judges be reduced?

Arguments: I. Yes, it will speed up judicial process and many people are likely to get justice in reasonable time.

II. Yes, it is a sign of British legacy, why should we carry it further?

Ans. (1)

Taking into account the fact, that a large number of cases are pending in the courts for a long time, it is desirable that vacations of court judges must be reduced to speed up judicial process, therefore, argument II is based on an example and we know that citing an example is a bad argumentation.

22. **Statement:**Should the practice of transfers of clerical cadre's employees from one city to another government offices be stopped?

Argument: I. No, transfer of employees is a routine administrative matter and we must continue it.

II. Yes, it involves lot of governmental expenditure and inconvenience to many compared to the benefits it yields.

Ans. (4)

It is not necessary that if any practice which has been in vogue for long time is right and it must be continued. Therefore, argument I is not strong. Argument II is partly true and hence it, cannot be strong.

23. **Statement:**Should higher qualification be the only criteria for internal promotions in any organisation?

Arguments: I. Yes, why not? In fact only higher qualification is more important than other factors.



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Analytical Reasoning-Strong and Weak Arguments

II. No, quality of performance and other factors are more important than mere higher qualification in case of internal promotion.

Ans. (4)

It is an established fact that higher qualification could not be only criteria for any kind of promotion in an organisation. Other factors are also equally important. It is very difficult to assess the higher qualification and other factors on the same scale. Therefore, neither of the arguments is strong.

24. **Statement:** Should Indian scientists working abroad be called back to India?

Arguments: I. Yes, they must serve the motherland first and forget about discoveries, honours, facilities and all.

II. No, we have enough talent, let them stay where they want.

Ans. (4)

Neither of the arguments is strong. None of the arguments holds strong vis-a-vis the statement.

25. **Statement:** Should the school teachers be necessarily involved in the census activities?

Arguments: I. No, this will adversely affect the quality of teaching programme.

II. Yes, the teachers are the best fit for this job.

Ans. (4)

None of the arguments is strong. The census activities take a few days and the loss incurred in the classes can be compensated by organising extra classes or pruning the holidays. Therefore, argument I is not strong. Other persons may also accomplish the task of census very well. Therefore, argument II is also not strong.

26. **Statement:** Should India engage into a dialogue with neighbouring countries to stop cross border tension?

Arguments: I. Yes, this is the only way to reduce the cross border tension.

II. No, neighbouring countries cannot be relied upon in such matters, they may still engage in subversive activities.

Ans. (1)

Only argument I holds strong. In the present context the solution of any major problem lies in the proper dialogue between the concerned parties. Argument II is based on individual's opinion and hence it cannot be strong.



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Analytical Reasoning-Strong and Weak Arguments

27. **Statement:**Should all the utility services be immediately brought under essential services to avoid frequent agitation and strikes by the employees?

Arguments: I. No, otherwise how the employees may voice their grievances and demands.

II. Yes, the employees are becoming more greedy and they take the general public for a ride by striking work.

Ans. (4)

None of the arguments is strong. The employees may raise their demands by other means also.

28. **Statement:**Should all the unauthorised structures in the city be immediately demolished?

Arguments: I. No, where will the people residing in such houses live?

II. Yes, this will give a clear message to general public and they will refrain from constructing unauthorised buildings.

Ans. (2)

Only argument II is strong. Unauthorised constructions create many other problems. The people may be shifted to some regularised colonies.

29. **Statement:**Should the railways in India be privatised in a phased manner like other public sector enterprises?

Arguments: I. Yes, this is the only way to bring in competitiveness and provide better service to the public.

II. No, this will pose a threat to national security of our country as multinational will enter into the fray.

Ans. (4)

The use of the word "only" in the argument I makes it invalid. The policy of open market advocates privatisation. Each country is opening its market for foreign investors. How, privatisation will pose a threat to national security?

30. **Statement:**Should the tenure of the President be longer?

Arguments: I. No, The president of India is non-executive head. Therefore, there is no need to extend his tenure.

II. Yes, it will provide an opportunity to President to guide the Government to fulfil the long term objectives.



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Analytical Reasoning-Strong and Weak Arguments

Ans. (4)

Neither of the arguments is strong enough. The President of India is constitutional head of the State, yet he is an integral part of the Parliament which decides policy matters. Therefore, argument I is not strong. The argument II does not mention any specific reason.

31. **Statement:**Should there be concentration of foreign investment in only few states?

Arguments: I. No, It is against the policy of overall development.

II. Yes, because a large number of States lack infrastructure to attract foreign investment.

Ans. (1)

Only argument I is strong. We cannot leave the backward region to remain backward.

32. **Statement:**Should there be a complete ban on opening up of new management educational institutions?

Arguments: I. Yes, there are more institutions than required and there is no need to open up new institutions.

II. No, we need more professional managers in coming days because the future scenario will be very competitive.

Ans. (2)

Managerial skill is required in every sphere of developmental activities and therefore, a complete ban on opening up of new management educational institutions is not justified in any way. Hence, only argument II is strong.

33. **Statement:**Should private organisations be allowed to carry on security related research activities?

Arguments: I. No, private organisations are easily vulnerable to our enemies and therefore, they should not be permitted to carry on such researches.

II. Yes, the Government has not sufficient resources to carry on such researches would manage necessary resources.

Ans. (4)

At a glance both the arguments seem to be strong. But considering the very nature of the private organisation, i.e. profit making only, we cannot hand over such great responsibility in the hands of private companies. Again, the argument I does not mention how the private organisations are easily vulnerable to our enemies.



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Analytical Reasoning-Strong and Weak Arguments

34. **Statement:**Should there be recruitment in banks on the basis of past academic performances rather than through competitive examinations?

Arguments:I. Yes, it will be beneficial for those candidates who are unable to bear the expenses of competitive examinations.

II. No, The past academic performance cannot be made the basis of recruitment because there is no uniformity in the assessment by the universities.

Ans. (4)

Neither of the arguments is strong enough. None of the arguments passes the desire ability criteria.

35. **Statement:**Should the examination bodies for all university examinations permit the use of calculators?

Arguments:I. No, it is necessary for the students to know the methods of manual calculation to make their concepts clear.

II. Yes, manual calculations are no more required with extensive use of computers in all fields.

Ans. (1)

Only argument I seems to be strong. Any electronic device like computer can be used effectively if the concepts are clear.

36. **Statement:**Should all the criminals convicted for committing murder be awarded capital punishment?

Arguments: I. Yes, this will be a significant step towards reducing cases of murder in future.

II. No, nobody has the right to take any person's life irrespective of the acts of such individuals.

Ans. (1)

Argument I seems to be strong.

37. **Statement:**Should all the professional colleges in India be encouraged to run their own courses without affiliation to any university?

Arguments: I. Yes, this is only way to create more opportunities for those who seek professional training.



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Analytical Reasoning-Strong and Weak Arguments

II. No, this will dilute the quality of professional training as all such colleges may not be equipped to conduct such courses.

Ans. (4)

The mention of the term 'only' in argument I makes it invalid. Argument II is also invalid.

38. **Statement:** Should there be a compulsory military training for each college student in India?

Arguments: I. No, this goes against the basic democratic right of an individual to choose his/her own programs.

II. Yes, this is the only way to build a strong and powerful nation.

Ans. (1)

Argument I seems to be strong.

39. **Statement:** Should the existing labour law be changed in the favour of owners?

Arguments: I. Yes, because the existing labour laws give much more protection to employees than required and thus production is reduced.

II. No, because owners would exploit employees as before when there were no labour laws.

Ans. (4)

According to statement, neither arguments I and II are strong.

40. **Statement:** Should all the power generation and distribution units in the state Y be handed over to the private sector?

Arguments: I. Yes, the state governments are not equipped to handle generation and distribution of electricity efficiently and it is not beneficial too.

II. Yes, the private companies handle generation and distribution of electricity efficiently.

Ans. (4)

Neither argument I nor argument II is strong.

None of the arguments cites any fact.